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Texas Hopes Three Charm in Managers

MINNEAPOLIS (AP) — Eddie Stanky abruptly quit as manager of the Texas Rangers Thursday after only one game to return to his former job as a college coach.

Third base coach Connie Ryan was named interim manager by Eddie Robinson, executive vice president of the Rangers. Although there was no official announcement, it was expected that Ryan will take over for the remainder of the season.

Robinson said no decision would be made on another manager until he discussed the matter with team owner Brad Corbett.

Ryan, 37, a former major league second baseman for the old Boston Braves, Cincinnati Reds and Philadelphia Phillies, became the Rangers' third manager in three games, as Texas wound up a four-game series with the Minnesota Twins Thursday.

Robinson was fired as Rangers' manager only 24 hours earlier. Stanky, 59, made an comeback as a major league manager as Texas overcame a 4-0 deficit to defeat the Twins 10-4 Wednesday night.

A startled Robinson received a

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telephone call about 8:15 a.m. Thursday from Stanky, who was at the airport heading for home.

"You've got to be kidding," Robinson said Stanky.

Robinson said Stanky responded that he

had thought it over all night, decided that he couldn't leave his family and aged father. "He had deep pangs of remorse," said Robinson.

Robinson said Stanky told him, "You've got a good ball club, you've given me a wonderful contract and I know what I'm turning down."

The Rangers were in a third-place tie with Kansas City in the American League West, four games behind first-place Chicago when Stanky left.

Robinson said he urged Stanky to stay at the airport until he could get there so they could discuss the matter face-to-face.

Robinson said Stanky replied, "No, I've made my decision. There will be no second thoughts."

Stanky had managed the St. Louis Cardinals for four years in the 1950s and played the Chicago White Sox for three years in the late 1960s. For the past five years he had been head baseball coach at the University of South Alabama in Mobile.

At Mobile, the school's athletic director, Mel Lucas, said Stanky was "honest" and found out quickly that he didn't want to return to the major leagues.

Lucas said Stanky's wife, Dickie, told

him of the sudden change of plans and "she was shocked as well as all of us."

The Stankys have six children, including three still at home.

"I don't think anyone can understand how strong his family ties are," Minnesota Manager Gene Mauer said of Stanky.

Bert Hawkins, the Rangers' traveling secretary, said he spent some time with Stanky after Wednesday night's game and said Stanky was "smiling and very happy" when he went to his hotel room.

Rangers Accept News; Front Office Ribbed

BLOOMINGTON, Min. (AP) — Texas Rangers players couldn't believe the news Thursday when they wandered into the lobby of a Minneapolis hotel to learn that Eddie Stanky had already decided to go back to college life.

"Who's gonna manage?" asked several of the players, who had just lost Stanky for the first time a few hours before.

Many of the players accepted Stanky's departure, while others had a good laugh at the Rangers' front office.

"Obviously after so many years of coaching college baseball, he decided that major league managing is a little bit more than he wanted," said Texas outfielder Ken Henderson. "I can feel for him in that situation."

Stanky had just met the players at 6 p.m. Wednesday and he returned on the team bus with him to the hotel after a 10-4 victory over Minnesota.

"He was only here for one game, so I don't know how it'll affect us," said Texas relief pitcher Adrian Devine. "I'm just glad to be here."

Veteran shortstop Bert Campaneris had no problem accepting the latest news. "This happened all the time when I was in Oakland," he said.

"This is getting to be like a Barmen and Bailey throwing circus," said another Rangers player. "Who do you suppose will be here today?"

Rangers vice president Eddie Robinson said Connie Ryan would take over as interim manager—the Rangers' third in three days and seventh since they moved from Washington in 1972.

Pitching coach Sid Hutton said Stanky scribbled notes dutifully during the game Wednesday night and seemed delighted with the performance and attitude of the players and coaches.



Wife Dickie Greets Stanky at Mobile Airport

Manager For A Day Nothing New

Baseball — vintage 1977 — that wonderful, enjoyable, often wacky, novelty we have long known as the National Pastime, will in all probability be remembered by future historians of the sport as the Year of the One Day Manager.

Baseball circles merely guffawed and chuckled earlier this season when Ted Turner, the flamboyant owner of the Atlanta Braves, ordered manager Dave Bristol to take a rest and assumed the field managing chores himself.

The Braves were mired in a club record 16-game losing streak at the time and the fact that the Pittsburgh Pirates extended it to 17 was not a momentous development. The fact, however, that the Pirates managed to win a 2-1 victory may stand tall in Turner's favor should he ever decide to try for another managing job.



Ron Barnes Sports Editor

Feeney Caused One

National League President Chub Feeney stepped in and cut the international yachtsman's managing career short, citing a seldom used, and hardly known, rule concerning conflict of interest.

So, the young sports magnate's field career was limited to one day and third base coach Vern Bengson took over as manager for a day. It remains unknown if the Braves' victory that day, snapping a then 17-game losing streak, was due to the law of averages or the sheer delight of getting a baseball man back in the dugout.

The Turner episode certainly

caused an unusual wave in the often stormy baseball seas, but the latest production of Manager For A Day — it might just become an afternoon television regular — had even the casual baseball fan commenting.

When Eddie Stanky, the famous "Brat" of yesteryears on the diamond, accepted an offer from the Texas Rangers to become their manager, a long and amiable chat at his invitation into the Alabama Hall of Fame last winter was recalled.

But, while scrambling through a myriad of notebooks to refresh the memory of that evening, along came the stunning account of Stanky's sudden change of heart.

Eddie Stanky was homesick and wanted to be closer to his family. No man can be faulted for that decision. That decision, however, increased the search for notebooks to include baseball's recent books. Interesting facts were found in both when they were uncovered.

And hellos and congratulations for his selection into the Hall of Fame, Stanky quipped about his taking the University of South Alabama head

coaching job nine years ago. "In my heart I knew that it would be my last baseball job."

The 59-year old Stanky went on to say, "Alabama and Auburn have long used my major league career against me in recruiting. They'd tell a youngster, 'Why go there, he's going back to the big leagues in a couple years.' I was always hard to convince the kids that I loved this job and was going to stay right at South Alabama."

Recruiting Help

With his overnight trip to Minneapolis, Minn., where his Rangers' four-day-defeated Minnesota, Stanky may well have unloaded some mighty Alabama and Auburn ammunition when they all go to the recruiting wars.

Upon arrival back in Mobile Thursday, South Alabama President Dr. Frederick Whiddon asked him if he was home for good.

"Damn right I am," Stanky boomed without hesitation.

Rambling through the manager's section of the baseball record book yesterday, when the man leaves before everybody knows he's been there.

This game of musical managers is not new, but it gets somewhat exciting, and amusing, when the man leaves before everybody knows he's been there.

It'll probably happen again. We'll just have to wait and see if any future year can better 1977's double dip.

managerial stands that stretched into 1968.

Sawyer called it quits after the opening game of 1960, and Andy Cohen handled the Phils on April 14, their next outing, and then turned it over to Gene Mauch for the third game on April 16. Mauch then lasted until after the first game of a June 14, 1960 doubleheader when George Mypitt took over for the nightcap. Mypitt did manage to stick around for a full day, however, managing the Phils June 15 before Bob Skinner took over on June 16.

Moss Got in Act

The White Sox version of Manager For A Day is particularly interesting because of the man involved — Stanky and Montgomery Rebel favorite Lou Moss.

In this case, however, Stanky was in the opening act of the saga.

On July 11, 1966, the Hot was relieved of his manager's duties and Moss was in charge when the Sox took the field on July 12. But, before the empire could yell "Play Ball!" a second time Moss had been replaced by Al Lopez.

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It'll probably happen again. We'll just have to wait and see if any future year can better 1977's double dip.

Braves Hand Tobik 1st Loss

SAVANNAH — Montgomery's latest winning streak ended at three games here Thursday night and relief ace Dave Tobik suffered his first loss of the year as the Savannah Braves scored once in the bottom of the ninth inning to edge the Rebels, 9-7, at Grayson Stadium.



ROD CAREW

The opener of the four-game series was the only one that will be played before the home folks. The two teams will play three games at Atlanta Stadium starting Friday afternoon. Mike Burns (8-5) will pitch for the Reds against Savannah lefty Larry McWilliams (3-4) in Friday's 1:30 p.m. (CDT) contest.

The Braves won the opener of the series when lefty Julio Alonso walked home the winning run in the ninth. Glenn Hubbard led the frame with a double off Tobik and Roger Ceder was safe on a fielder's choice with Hubbard taking third.

Bruce Benedict walked, then Tobik fanned Al Ryan. Manager Eddie Brinkman brought in Alonso to face infatuated batter Jim Arline, who drew the walk to force in the clincher.

A walk, error, Terry Lynch's sacrifice fly and Greg Shipley's single produced a pair of RBIs runs in the first off Savannah starter Steve Bus. It was 2-0 to 3-0 in the fourth as Ken Bolok doubled, Vercy Garrison singled and then stole second. Bolok scored when Benedict's throw is second was wild.

The Braves got two in the fifth off starter Steve Burnside, but the Rebels added a pair in the seventh as Lou Whitaker rallied for two runs.

The Braves pulled for a 5-5 tie in the seventh by getting three runs off Burnside, but the Rebels got two more in the eighth on a 3B-500 home run by Tim Burroughs, his fourth, after a single by Bolok.

Savannah got two more off Burnside in the bottom of the eighth to tie it again and set the stage for the ninth-inning uprising.



ROD CAREW

BUTCH HOBSON

Carew Up to .395; Twins Pound Rangers

BLOOMINGTON, Min. (AP) — Hollingford Rod Carew batted out three hits and American League RBI leader Larry Hise drove in two runs while Dave Goltz and the Minnesota Twins cruised to a 12-2 victory over the Texas Rangers Thursday.

The victory gave the Twins a split of the four-game series and spoiled the debut of Rangers interim Manager Connie Ryan, who took over when Eddie Stanky quit earlier in the day after managing only one game.

Carew singled twice and doubled to spark Minnesota's 15-hit attack while hitting his average to .395, highest in the major.

Hise slammed his 17th home run and also doubled in another run to take his RBI total to 66.

Hot Carlo belted home runs as the Cleveland Indians blanked the Toronto Blue Jays 4-0 Thursday night for their eighth straight victory.

Garland, 47, held Toronto hitless until the sixth when Doug Butler and Sam Dising singled as the Blue Jays mounted their only serious scoring threat of the game.

Boston Blitzes O's

BALTIMORE (AP) — Butch Hobson drove in two runs, one with a home run to extend Boston's record home run streak to 39 in nine consecutive games, and the Red Sox defeated Baltimore 7-3 Thursday night to complete a four-game sweep of the Orioles.

The breaking Red Sox have won seven in a row and 18 of their last 18 on route to grabbing the lead in the American League East. In the last seven games, they have out-homered contenders New York and Baltimore by a 2-5 margin.

Hobson cracked his 11th homer of the season in the second inning off Mike Flanagan, 24, and doubled home another run in the fourth. Steve Dillard hit a two-run home-run single in the eighth following an intentional walk.

Guerrero drove in the Angels' first three runs with a single in the second, a sacrifice fly in the fourth and another single in the sixth inning. Bonds' single in the seventh snapped a 6-4 tie and Humphrey's hit capped a five-run uprising in the ninth.

Mariners Win 10th

KANSAS CITY (AP) — Craig Reynolds singled to left field to score Dan Meyer and Fred Patek bobbed a soft liner by Steve Bauer to let another run score, as the Seattle Mariners defeated the Kansas City Royals 4-0 in Sunday's Thursday night.

Meyer doubled off Mark Littell, 54, to begin the uprising. Enrique Romo, 5-4, led the seventh snapping a 6-4 tie and Humphrey's hit capped a five-run uprising in the ninth.

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Tribe Wins 8th in Row

CLEVELAND (AP) — Wayne Garland singled a four-hit shutout and Buddy Bell and

'I Should Have Known Better,' Says Stanky

MOBILE, Ala. (AP) — Eddie Stanky returned into the grateful arms of his family Thursday after playing an unhappy manager-for-a-day role with the Texas Rangers.

"I should have known better," he said.

The 59-year old Stanky, his voice tired and soft, said he started having doubts on his way to Minneapolis, where the Rangers were in a series with the Minnesota Twins, and after his first day was over he found himself "lonesome and homesick."

Despite a 10-4 victory in his debut Wednesday night, he said he didn't sleep much at all. He was ready to come home by morning.

A former major league player who has been baseball coach at the University of South Alabama for the past five years, Stanky said he enjoyed his brief return to pro baseball and would have stayed "if I didn't

have to go to my room alone each night."

Dr. Frederick Whiddon, president of South Alabama, asked Stanky if he was home for good.

"Damn right I am," said Stanky.

Stanky's attractive brunette wife, Dickie, and four of his children, all with healthy good looks and beaming smiles, hugged him when he stepped off the airplane on his return from Minnesota. It wasn't difficult to see why he was homesick.

There were jokes, cheers and a few tears of joy. Stanky held his emotions in check.

He said his abrupt decision to quit had nothing to do with the Ranger halibuts or management.

"The attitude of the halibuts was great," he said, and there was a lot of jumping up and down "after Wednesday night's victory."

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